4.17 Deep Vein Thrombosis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My left calf is swollen and painful." **Objective** • Swelling of one calf • Warm and red • Positive Doppler ultrasound	**ACTUAL** Ineffective peripheral tissue perfusion related to venous obstruction as evidenced by swelling, warmth and pain in the affected limb.	• Swelling and pain decrease within 3–5 days.	• Give anticoagulation as prescribed. • Elevate the affected leg. • Measure calf circumference daily. • Do not massage the leg. • Encourage walking as permitted.	• Goal reached as swelling goes down.
Subjective • Rates pain 6/10 **Objective** • Calf tender • Guards the leg	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to venous inflammation as evidenced by calf tenderness and reported pain.	• Pain at or below 3/10.	• Give analgesia as prescribed; avoid NSAIDs with anticoagulants unless ordered. • Elevate the leg. • Fit a compression stocking when ordered.	• Met when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Venous thrombus	**RISK** Risk for excessive bleeding as evidenced by risk factors: anticoagulant therapy.	• No bleeding and no sign of pulmonary embolism.	• Follow clotting results as ordered. • Look for bleeding from the gums and in urine and stool. • Ask her to report sudden breathlessness or chest pain at once. • Check SpO_2 and respiratory rate.	• Achieved if there is no bleeding or embolism.

*References for this care plan: [5], [32], [35], [45], [84]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.